This copy is for your personal, non-commercial use only. Distribution and use of this material are governed by our Subscriber Agreement and by copyright law. For non-personal use or to order multiple copies, please contact Dow Jones Reprints at 1-800-843-0008 or visit www.djreprints.com.

https://www.wsj.com/world/china/chinese-exports-accelerated-in-september-188b0884

WORLD • CHINA

Chinese Exports Soar in September

Exports to the European Union surged 25.3%, while exports to the U.S. rose 40.0%

Oct. 14, 2026 12:41 am ET



China's Auto shipments surged 56.3%, driven by strong overseas appetite for electric vehicles. -/CN-STR/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

China's export growth accelerated in September, beating market expectations and potentially threatening to heighten trade tensions with major partners.

Exports rose 36.3% from a year earlier in September, accelerating from August's 25.0% increase, according to data released Wednesday by the General Administration of Customs. The reading topped the 25.0% increase forecast by economists in a Wall Street Journal survey.

Strong global demand for AI-related and green-tech products continued to drive exports, with semiconductors and computing equipment contributing more than 13 percentage points to overall export growth, said Nguyen Hoang Nam, an economist at Capital Economics.

Auto shipments surged 56.3%, driven by strong overseas appetite for electric vehicles, he said.

A regional breakdown showed that exports to the European Union surged 25.3% from a year earlier, accelerating from a 6.6% rise in August. Shipments to Southeast Asia, China's largest trading partner bloc, soared 52.3%, while exports to the U.S., its third-largest trading partner, rose 40%.

The strong exports widened China's trade surplus to $133.5 billion in September from $119.1 billion in August, and exceeded the $111.4 billion forecast by economists. Imports also grew rapidly, rising 31.0% from a year earlier.

The latest figures come amid mounting trade friction with the European Union, which has pressed Beijing to address a widening trade imbalance and flagged concerns over competition from Chinese manufacturers.

Earlier this month, the two sides reached an understanding on Chinese hybrid and plug-in hybrid vehicle exports to the bloc—an arrangement that could cut Chinese shipments by more than half.

Despite the strong trade performance, China continues to grapple with sluggish domestic demand, as a prolonged property downturn and subdued consumer spending weigh on the broader economic recovery.

Separate data released Wednesday showed consumer prices rose 0.9% from a year earlier in September, ticking up from August's 0.8% increase but falling short of the 1.0% growth forecast by economists in a Wall Street Journal survey.

China is estimated to report third-quarter economic growth of 4.4%, according to forecasts by economists. While an improvement from 4.3% in the second quarter, the figure would remain below Beijing's full-year target range of 4.5% to 5%.

Write to Singapore editors at singaporeeditors@dowjones.com